

Executive Summary

Stater Bros. Markets — December 2025 Sales Forecasting

Stater Bros. Markets operates 169 locations across Southern California in one of retail's most margin-sensitive environments. In December, the highest revenue month of the year, forecast accuracy directly impacts inventory planning and carrying costs across the chain.

Bottom Line

The Holt-Winters model forecasts December 2025 chain-wide sales at **\$239,481,293**, representing a per-store planning target of **\$1,417,049** with a planning range of **\$1,128,113 – \$1,705,985**. At a 20.39% forecast error rate, this represents **\$48.8M in chain-wide planning uncertainty** buyers must plan around.

Model Selected: Holt-Winters (MNM)

Model	Test MAPE	Test RMSE
Holt-Winters (MNM)	20.39%	\$127.9M
Moving Average, MA(3)	29.43%	\$203.6M

Recommendations

- Retrain monthly as new sales data becomes available
- Add promotional calendars and holiday indicators to reduce forecast error
- Extend the dataset